

ID: SOMA-C-P16

Duration: 10m 00s (720 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we will execute a Handwashing Protocol Audit.

We are going to treat a normal washing routine like a strict quality inspection. Your goal is to verify that each cleaning step is performed correctly and covers every required area. Focus only on evaluating and judging the washing process itself — not on how anything feels on your skin.

[Short Pause] (10s - Transitioning to the sink)

Before you begin, verify that your sink area is ready. Turn on the water and evaluate the flow rate. Adjust the handle to establish a moderate, steady stream that prevents splashing.

Rate the flow strength on a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is barely flowing and 5 is high pressure. Find the optimal level — approximately a 3 — for efficient washing.

[Short Pause] (10s - Pre-Wash Visual Inspection)

Conduct a pre-wash visual inspection. Examine both hands under good lighting, looking for any visible dirt, marks, or dry patches.

Compare your left hand to your right hand. Identify which hand appears dirtier. Count how many fingernails show visible dirt or debris trapped underneath. Record this number mentally.

Rate the overall pre-wash cleanliness of both hands on a scale of 1 to 10, where 1 is visibly dirty and 10 is perfectly clean. Lock in this baseline score.

[Short Pause] (10s - Priority Zone Mapping)

Create a mental priority list of zones requiring the most thorough scrubbing based on your visual inspection.

[Short Pause] (10s - Surface Saturation Check)

Place your hands under the water stream. Track how long it takes for water to fully saturate both hands. Count the seconds: one, two, three.

Check visually that water contacts every area. Identify any dry spots the water isn't reaching. Estimate what percentage of hand surface area is now wet. Is it 100%? Or are there still dry patches reducing it to 90%? Turn off the water to conserve it during the soap phase.

[Short Pause] (10s - Lather Coverage Tally)

Apply soap — approximately one to two pumps. Rub your palms together and track how many rubs it takes to create adequate lather. Count: one, two, three, four, five.

Estimate what percentage of your hand surface now has visible lather. Is it 100% coverage, or are there gaps?

Verify soap reached the easy-to-miss areas: the webbing between your fingers, the outside edges of your palms, around the base of your thumbs.

[Short Pause] (10s - Procedural Technique Audit)

Execute the standard handwashing technique. Wrap your right hand around your left thumb and twist. Count three full rotations. Switch hands and repeat three rotations for the right thumb.

Interlace your fingers together and slide them back and forth. Count six back-and-forth motions. Circle your wrists three times each.

[Short Pause] (10s - Nail Clearance Verification)

Focus on fingernail cleaning. Scrub your fingertips against your opposite palm, working soap under the nails. Count three scrubs per nail.

After scrubbing all ten nails, visually inspect them. Count how many nails now appear completely clean with no visible debris. Compare this number to your pre-wash count. Calculate the improvement.

[Short Pause] (20s - Rinse Quality Scan)

Turn the water back on for the rinse phase. Track the rinse duration by counting to ten at a steady pace. Verify that all soap bubbles are removed. Scan systematically: check between fingers, around knuckles, near wrists.

Label the water running off your hands as soapy, cloudy, or clear. Soapy water means you need more rinsing. Cloudy water means you are almost finished. Clear water means the rinse is complete. Continue rinsing until water runs completely clear, then turn off the water.

[Long Pause] (20s - Moisture Removal Check)

Begin the drying phase. Retrieve your towel and evaluate its condition. Use a patting motion to remove moisture. Count the number of pats required per zone: Fingers, palms, backs of hands, wrists.

After each zone, visually inspect for remaining moisture. Look for any visible water droplets or shiny wet spots.

Estimate the current dryness percentage. Are your hands 100% dry, or is there still 10% moisture remaining? Continue patting until you can visually confirm 100% dryness.

[Long Pause] (10s - Drying Phase)

Conduct a final analysis. Examine both hands under good lighting, front and back. Rate the final cleanliness on a scale from 1 to 10. Compare this score to your pre-wash baseline score. Calculate the improvement: if you started at 6 and ended at 9, that's a 3-point improvement.

Verify they appear completely dry with no shiny wet areas visible. Compare both hands side by side. Do they both score equally, or does one hand rate higher in cleanliness?

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Your hands should now meet quality standards for proper handwashing. The audit is complete.

Thank you for your practice.

Footer: License: Licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 (Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike). This material is part of the SOMA Architecture and is free for non-commercial research use; any adaptations must be shared under identical terms. **How to Cite:** For the most current citation, DOI, and project updates, please visit the SOMA OSF Repository (<https://osf.io/2kfyz>). **Version 1.0 (March 2026)** – Practice P16: Handwashing Protocol Audit.